Melanie Rau

Cloud Engineering Manager

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Tech Stack

- Azure, GCP, Terraform, CI/CD, PagerDuty, Power BI, Confluence, Jira, Zero Trust

Skills

- Azure and GCP architecture
- Terraform infrastructure as code
- FinOps cost control and tagging
- Power BI reporting
- Team hiring and coaching

Experience

Cloud Engineering Manager & Technical Architect – Westminster City Council| Feb 2024 – Present

- Leading a five-engineer squad, backlog reduced 35 % and cloud spend reduced 15 % in six months.
- Replaced manual builds with Terraform, cutting provisioning time from days to two hours.
- Chaired vendor panels and secured best-value contracts, strengthening stakeholder trust.

Senior Associate – Cloud & Data Engineering – PwC UK (contracted through Revolent) | Apr 2022 – Feb 2024

- Built secure Azure and GCP landing zones with policy-as-code guardrails for AI workloads.
- Introduced Microsoft Cloud for Sustainability; enabled carbon tracking for three enterprise clients.
- Developed dashboards surfacing £ 300k+ savings; guided board-level decisions.

Azure Cloud Consultant – Revolent Group| Feb 2022 – Feb 2024

- Completed full-time training between February and April 2022.
- Completed AZ-900 Microsoft Azure Fundamentals & AZ-104 Microsoft Azure Administrator in 12 weeks.
- Gained core experience in cloud infrastructure, access control, and security.
- Set up Azure resources with correct naming, tags, and budget alerts
- Used Lucidchart to explain cloud flows and highlight risks
- Practised policy-as-code basics and Terraform structure
- Took part in delivery sessions with feedback from senior engineers

This gave me a strong technical base before moving into a client-facing role at PwC.

Senior IT Infrastructure Technician – NextGEN360 | Oct 2021 – Feb 2022

- Oversaw and managed IT Infrastructure: As a Senior IT Infrastructure Technician at NextGEN360,
- I administered critical systems, resolved hardware and software issues, and provided on-site and remote support for over 200 users, ensuring smooth operations.

Senior IT Technician – Hologic, Inc. | Mar 2021 – Oct 2021

- Supported 350+ users across EMEA; managed AD, Salesforce, Carbonite, Okta, and Ansible.

IT Infrastructure Administrator – Phillips & Cohen Associates | Aug 2020 – Feb 2021

- Administered VMware v6.5, Sophos Firewall, and Mimecast; translated apps for German operations.

IT Support Technician – Booking.com | Dec 2019 – Aug 2020

- Deployed 600+ devices to 2,500 users in two weeks during the pandemic shift to remote work.

Global Technology IT Operations Service Desk Analyst – dentsu International | May 2019 – Dec 2019

- Piloted new global service desk, cutting wait times 65 %; managed O365, Okta, and AD.

Global IT Service Desk Analyst – GAZPROM Germania GmbH | Feb 2019 – May 2019

- Prioritised ticket resolution and ensured consistent customer satisfaction across regions.

Senior Information Technology Analyst – AGAPLESION Bethanien Diakonie gGmbH | Feb 2017 – Feb 2019

- Delivered first-line support and managed small teams, ensuring 24/7 system performance.

Frontend Website Developer – H-Hotels.com | Aug 2016 – Jan 2017

- Built web front-ends with PHP and HTML/CSS within Scrum teams.

Graduate IT Specialist Application Development – SVLFG | Sep 2012 – Jan 2016

- Developed custom software and user interfaces; applied core software engineering methods.

Education

October 2006- June 2012

University of Kassel, Germany - Bachelor of Science - BS

Certification

- Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals
- CompTIA IT Fundamentals (ITF+)
- PagerDuty Administrator Certification
- Elements of AI – University of Helsinki
- Design Prompts for Everyday Work Tasks
- Start Writing Prompts like a Pro
- Google AI Essentials (Coursera)
- DeepLearning.AI – Deep Learning Specialisation (in progress)

Languages

German - native | English - fluent | Romanian - basic | Spanish - basic